52. Networking Interview & Oncall Drills

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Phase: Phase 11 — Observability and troubleshooting
Estimated time: 2 days
Slug: `52-interview-net`

Learning objectives

- Explain issues aloud with structure
- Whiteboard a path
- Solve timed scenarios
- Prioritize user impact

Prerequisites

Complete prior lessons. Prefer a Linux VM for `ip`/`ss`/`nft` examples; macOS works for many `curl`/`dig` drills.

Scenarios:

- Users in one city cannot login
- Intermittent TLS failures
- DNS works for you, not for customers
- Pod cannot reach DB
- Site slow only on mobile networks

Use the playbook; narrate evidence.

Common mistakes

- Jumping to rare root causes first
- No communication
- Fixing without verifying

Exercises

Work in `exercises/52-interview-net/`:

```
./test.sh
```

- **A:** make tests pass
- **B:** run 2–3 real commands from this lesson in your lab and note outputs
- **C:** rewrite answers from memory next day

Do not open `solutions/52-interview-net/` until after an honest attempt.

Self-check

1. One-city issue first suspects?

2. TLS intermittent ideas?
3. Verify how?

Further reading

- https://sre.google/sre-book/managing-incidents/